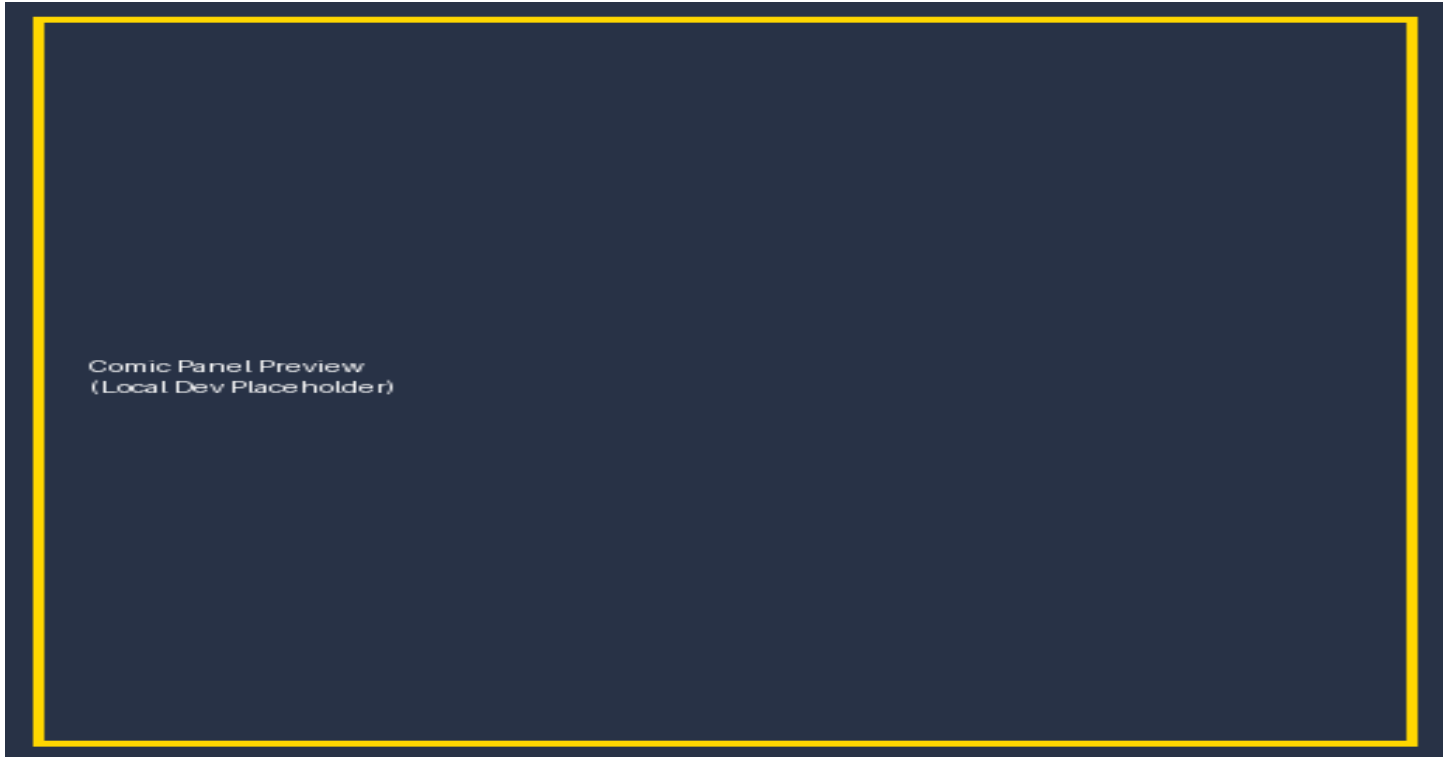


Panel 1



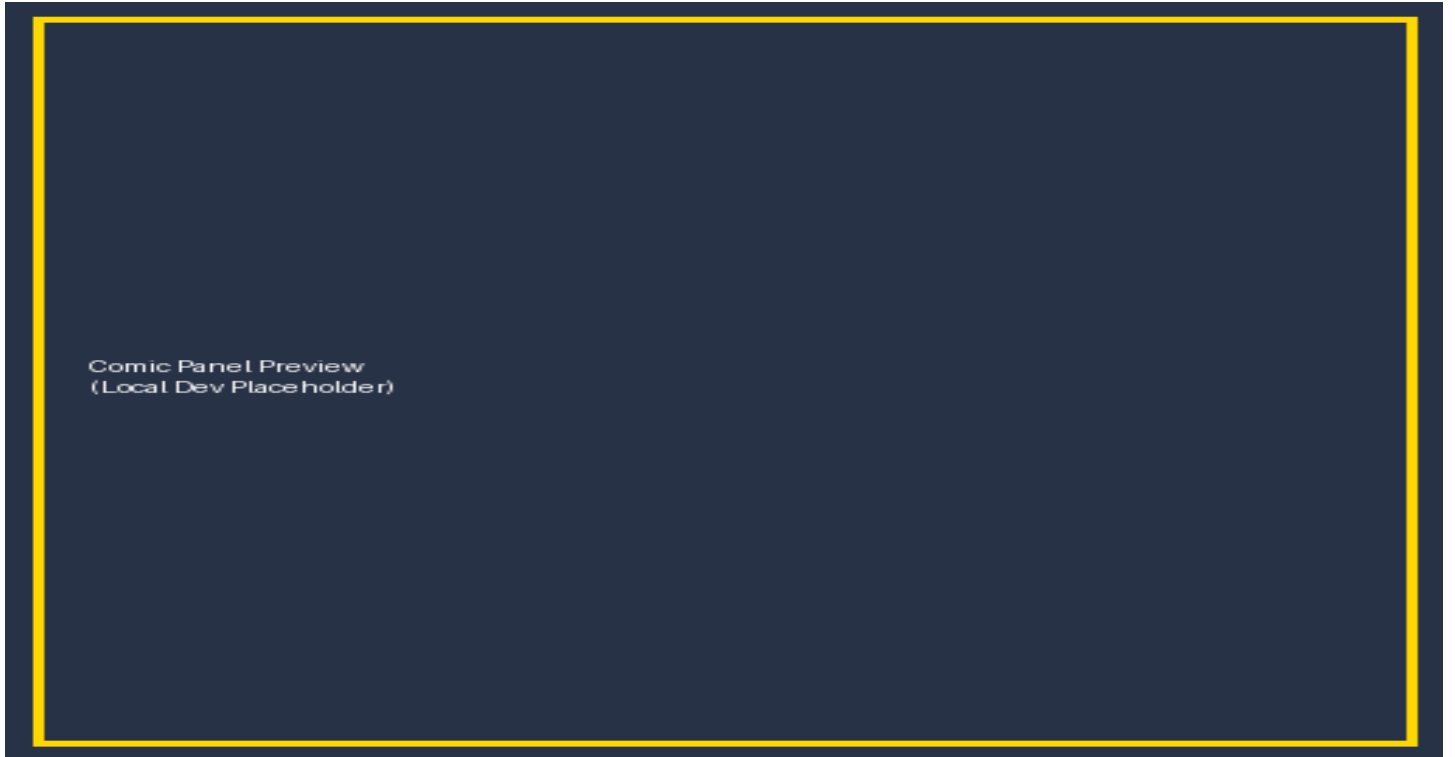
The Threshold

CAPTION: The Great Wilds outside the borderlands. A place where legends end and nightmares begin.

NARRATION: They said only fools walked beneath the boughs of the Whispering Woods. But Aria wasn't one for folklore?she was a vixen on a mission.

ARIA: (gritting her teeth against the freezing gale, her fur standing completely on end) Just a few miles past the jagged rocks, they said. Nobody mentioned the air would feel like it?s biting back!

Panel 2



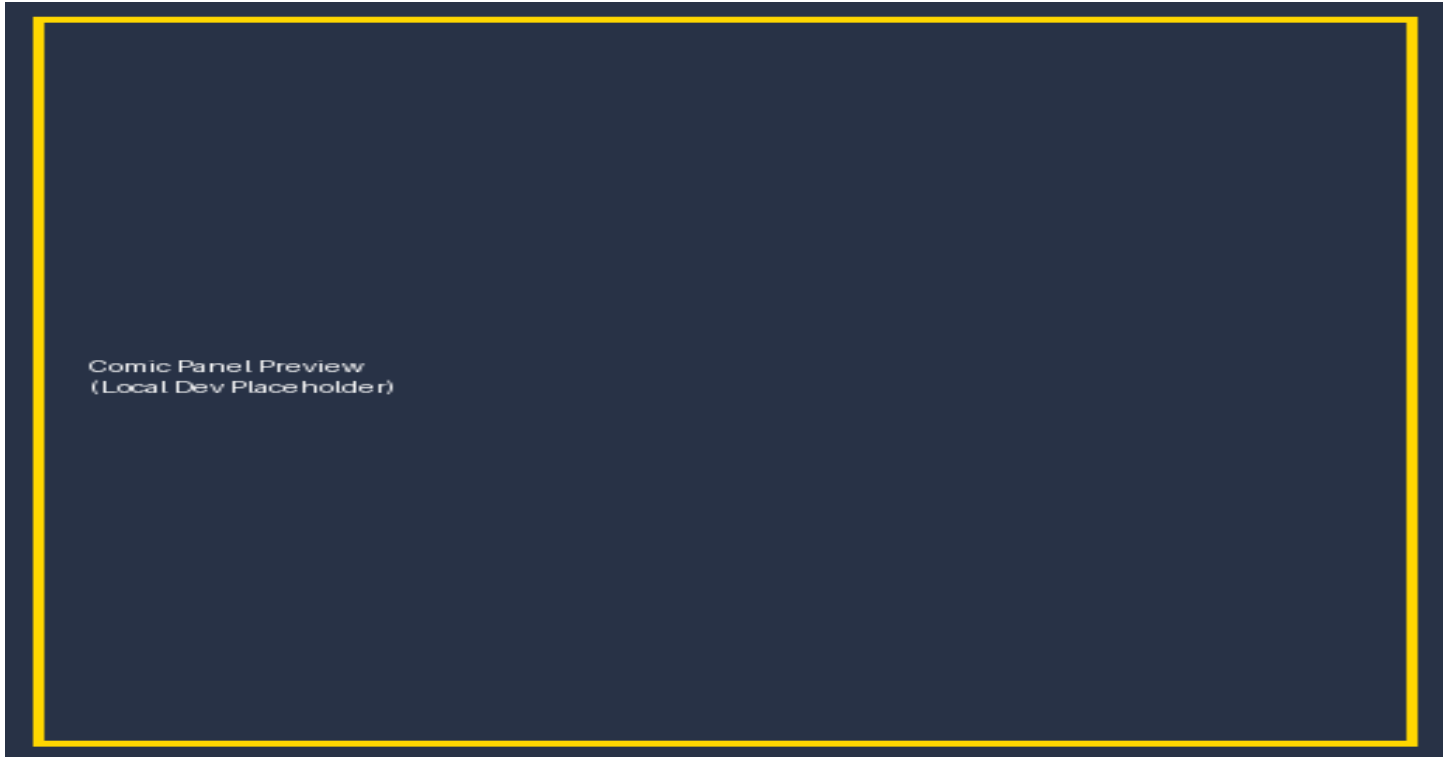
Into the Shadows

CAPTION: Crossing the veil. Point of no return.

NARRATION: With a final, steady breath, the young fox plunges past the gnarled sentinels of the border. Instantly, the sun is swallowed whole, replaced by the sickly, throbbing pulse of bioluminescent roots.

ARIA: (whispering to herself, eyes wide as a neon-blue mushroom casts an eerie glow across her snout) Okay, Aria. Stay close to the ground. Watch your paws. And whatever you do... don't lick the glowing moss.

Panel 3



The Whispering Mist

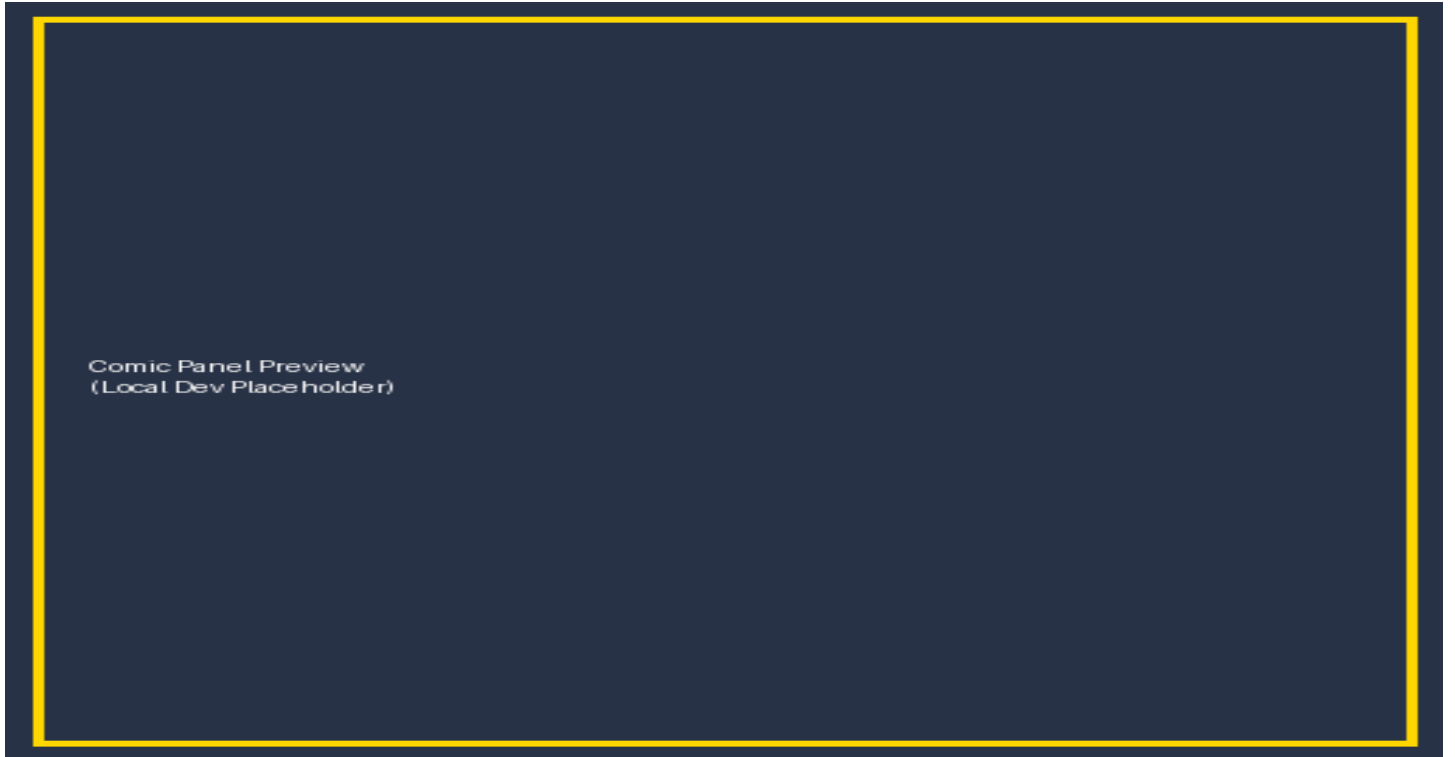
CAPTION: The forest doesn't just watch. It whispers.

NARRATION: The fog rolls in thick and heavy, freezing the very marrow in her bones. It writhes, twisting into mocking, phantom grins that claw at her senses!

PHANTOM VOICES: (echoing from the mist) Turn baaaack, little fox... You are dust upon the wind...
Lost forever...

ARIA: (swinging her head sharply, teeth bared) Save your breath, fog! I've heard worse grumbles from my den-master before breakfast!

Panel 4



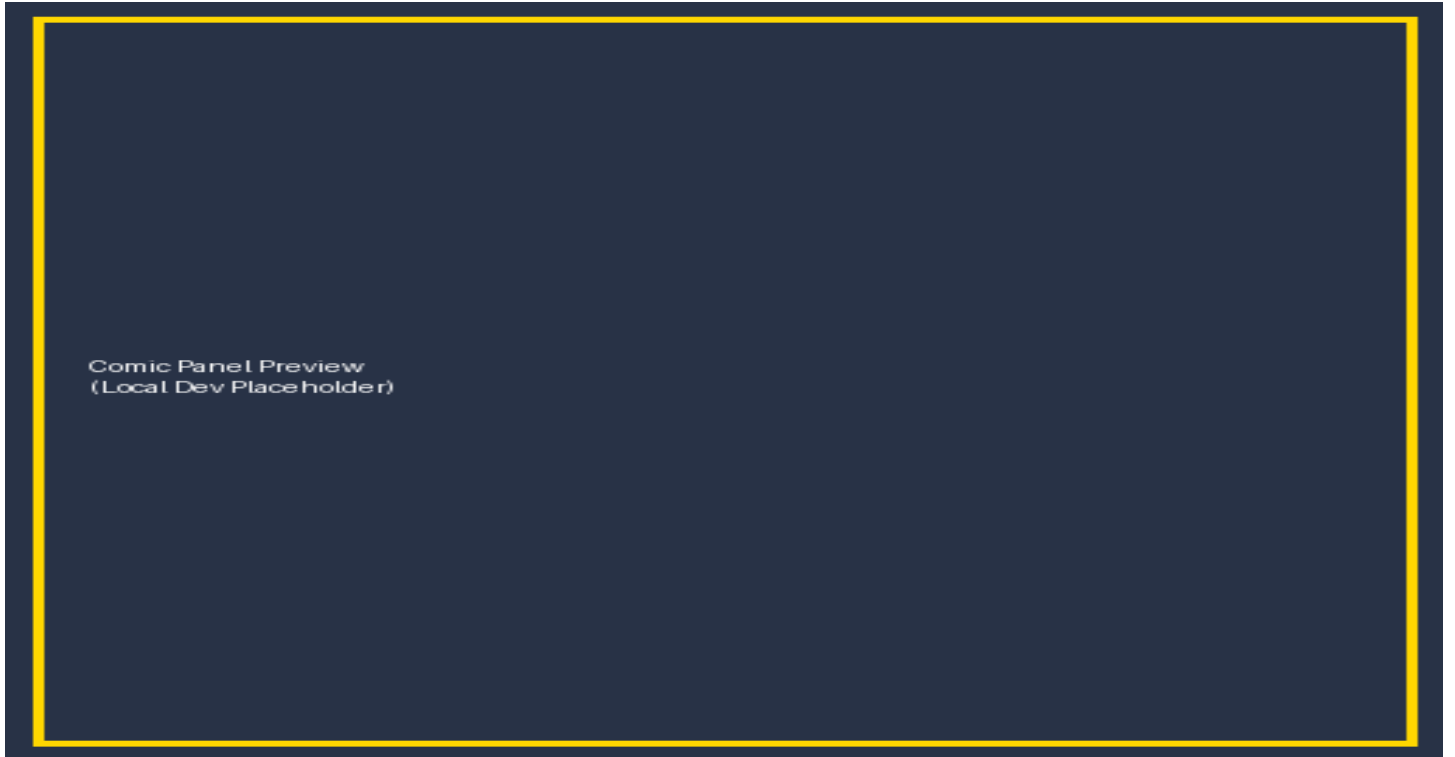
The Guardian's Challenge

CAPTION: End of the path. Enter the Star-Stag.

NARRATION: The mist parts with a violent hiss, revealing a clearing that burns with the light of a thousand supernovas. Blocking the heart of the forest stands a titan forged of pure starlight and ancient wrath.

STAR-STAG: (its voice booming like rolling thunder, antlers blazing with celestial fire) MORTAL PAW HAS NO BUSINESS HERE. STATE YOUR PURPOSE, LITTLE THIEF, BEFORE I SCATTER YOUR SPIRIT TO THE COSMOS.

Panel 5



Unwavering Resolve

CAPTION: Courage isn't the absence of fear. It's staring the galaxy in the face and refusing to blink.

NARRATION: Towered over by a beast of pure cosmic energy, most creatures would turn tail and run. But Aria... Aria is forged of sterner stuff.

ARIA: (narrowing her eyes, stepping forward with a fearless, blazing intensity) I'm not here to steal, and I'm definitely not turning back. Move, constellation, or I'll find out if starlight tastes like chicken!